all players and I'd do no different. After that the issue wasn't raised again and I had put it out of my mind by the time I went to bed.

In the final, Australia batted first and put 272 runs on the board. It was a very good score, considering it was the final. We couldn't afford to lose an early wicket and I knew I had to stay in to set up the game. People were expecting me to blast the Australian attack from ball one, but that was an impossible proposition. Perhaps in people's minds I could just pick up from where I had left off two nights before. The reality, of course, was different. It was a new match and I was starting a new innings. I had to play myself in all over again and it wasn't going to be easy.

To make matters more difficult, the Australians bowled a good line and I had to work very hard not to get out. In the first over I faced against Damien Fleming, I played five dot-balls and was trying to leave the sixth ball, which hit my inside edge and went for a streaky boundary, missing the stumps by two inches. It was a lucky escape and I told myself that I was obviously still fatigued and wasn't moving my feet properly. I would have to spend time in the middle for my body to get used to the conditions and for my timing to come back.

We managed to score just 12 in the first five overs and the Australians continued to apply pressure by bowling a very tight line around the off stump. There were no loose balls on offer and I wasn't happy. The pressure was mounting and it was time to try something different. I was forced to take a risk to push the run rate up and so I came down the wicket to Michael Kasprowicz in the sixth over of our innings. I managed to connect well and the ball soared over the boundary. The crowd was in raptures and the bowler was taken by surprise. I now anticipated that he'd bowl me a bouncer the very next ball. It is a fast bowler's natural response and I was more than prepared for it. I stayed back in the crease and easily hit the short ball for another six. It definitely rattled Kasprowicz and the Australians. The risks I had taken had paid off and the touch had come back. There was no need for any further risk-taking and the run chase was back on track.

With Nayan Mongia, who had been promoted up the order, and Azhar giving me good support, I was able to pace my innings without allowing the Australian bowlers to dominate and gradually the match was turning our way. Shane Warne tried coming round the wicket and yet again I countered him by hitting him over midwicket and square leg. With